

Can India Ever Become A Global FOSS Hub?

The open source trend is catching on in the IT and electronics space in India, with enterprises and SMEs taking the plunge. So, will India be the next FOSS hub? Or will the lack of a supportive ecosystem around FOSS come in the way of fulfilling such ambitions?

Free and open source software (FOSS) technology is creating a sensation in the Indian technology world. With IT and electronics companies aggressively adopting open source, sectors like the Indian government, SMEs, retail, BFSI, etc, are warming up to the benefits of free and open source software. Many are betting on India becoming the next FOSS hub. But does India have the ecosystem that could make this dream a reality?

Stumbling blocks like a dearth of advocacy, the Indian government still being FOSS-shy, and the fact that FOSS is still at a very nascent stage within the country might make India's emergence as a FOSS hub seem like a distant dream. However, this dark cloud has a silver lining. FOSS solution providers in India are realising the need for a give-and-take relationship with the community; the Indian consumer is maturing; virtual platforms/events are fostering collaboration; and the education industry is waking up to the new demands from the IT industry.

How far is India from becoming a FOSS hub?

Most FOSS advocates and experts believe that though India has taken long strides towards becoming a global FOSS hub,